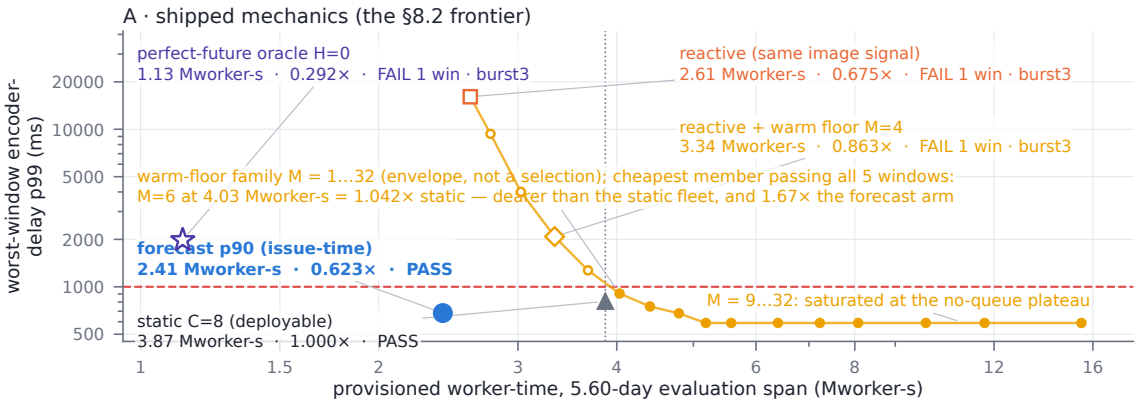
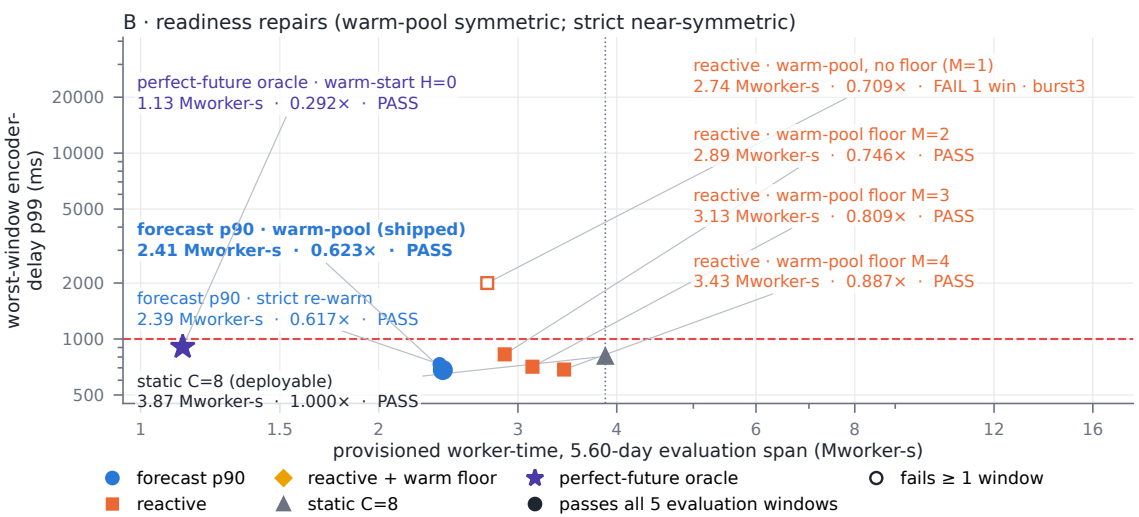
§8.2 encoder-pool frontier — provisioned worker-time vs worst-window tail over the 5.60-day evaluation span (gate: encoder-delay p99 < 1 s in every evaluation window; windows burst1 / burst3 / burst4 / burst5 / calm day)





Filled marker = passes all 5 evaluation windows; hollow = fails (count and window named in the label). Dashed red = the declared gate, encoder-delay p99 < 1 s; dotted grey = the static-C=8 cost reference. Both panels share log–log axes. Panel A is the frontier as run. Panel B removes the one undisclosed asymmetry — the forecast/oracle arms actuate through a warm pool, the reactive family through strict re-warm — by giving every arm the warm-pool readiness model (the strict forecast variant shown is a near-symmetric sensitivity, not an equalized arm), and lets the oracle order before its window opens. Even on that most-favourable-to-reactive footing the cheapest passing floor (M=2, 2.89 Mworker-s) costs 1.20× the forecast arm.